

Regular Meeting
Monday, January 13, 2020
Medford School Committee
Medford City Hall

Present: Ms. Graham, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. McLaughlin, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Lungo-Koehn, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson, Student Representative Isabella DeSouza.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:06pm.

Approval of the Minutes of January 6, 2020 - Motion to amend the address of Mr. Falco to Fulton Spring Road in Community Participation by Ms. Kreatz. Motion to approve as amended offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Ms. Kreatz - Some items are unclassified. Ms. Patterson - Those items are food service. Ms. Kreatz - On page four, building associates other items. Ms. Patterson - Those are pool supplies. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report of Secretary - Ms. Van der Kloot - I will be signing the bills on Wednesdays at 10:00am. I invite my colleagues to come join me if you are available at that time. If not, we can do it another time. Some weeks are heavier than other weeks. If you would like to join me, you can let me know. It is a valuable experience.

Report of Superintendent - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I welcome Mayor Lungo-Koehn, Jenny Graham, and Melanie McLaughlin to the School Committee. My mantra has been One Medford, One District. We are stronger when we work together. With my father's passing, I appreciate Diane Caldwell handling last week's School Committee meeting. In the case of inclement weather, my team is studying the possibility of implementing a two-hour delay schedule. June of 2020 is fast approaching, and seniors will need to order their caps and gowns this week and next week. The cost is \$20 per student, cash or checks only. Upcoming key events for the listening audience: we will be making announcements about the middle school lottery process for incoming 6th graders, and incoming Kindergarten students for Building Bridges to Kindergarten.

There is no need to be nervous, you have not missed any deadlines yet, these are upcoming in February.

I would like to recognize Lou Mandarinini who went shopping with Vocational Craft Laborers students with Medford Rotary Club. They made gift baskets for Medford families. Dave McGillivray spoke at both middle schools, talking to them and motivating them to chase their dreams.

Since 1980 Medford has had a sister city in Japan: Nobeoka. They celebrate year-forgetting parties. I also learned about ikigai, which is your purpose in life. It teaches us to celebrate who you are, step away from our over-scheduled lives, and celebrate in the moment. I am glad to be back.

Proposed Meeting Dates: Budget Committee of the Whole FY21 - Kirsteen Patterson - This recommendation takes into account some of the areas that seemed to need extra time last year. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot. Ms. Kreatz - Last year Ms. DiBenedetto had suggested we record the meetings. I would like to suggest that because a lot of people did not even know we had the meetings. Ms. Patterson - I did not specifically indicate the location, that is up to the committee.

Motion to record meetings offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. McLaughlin, motion passes.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn - We will speak to Patrick Gordon and make sure we can record the meetings.

Ms. Kreatz - Can we post the meetings on the website? Can we put out a press release? I would like to have Lisa Evangelista write a release and share it widely. Motion to publicize the budget meetings offered by Ms. Kreatz.

Ms. McLaughlin - When will the dates be available on the website? Can the Committee of the Whole dates be added to a newsletter?

Ms. Graham - We should have a Committee of the Whole before these meetings begin for data and budget planning.

Motion to record the pre-budget meetings in room 207 offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot.

Motion to do a press release on social media on the budget subjects and times and to post on the website. Amended by Ms. McLaughlin to add the information to the newsletter. Further amended

by Ms. Graham to discuss data we would like to request and discuss budget planning. Motion passes.

Motion to approve offered by Ms. Graham, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, schedule adopted.

Report on Department of Health Services Best Practices - Toni Wray - These best practices go beyond standard band aids to optimize student health and wellness. Elementary nurses are screening for Amblyopia, which is the most common cause of preventable vision loss in children. At the high school, we are working on lessening the administration of Tylenol for minor complaints. At the Curtis-Tufts High School the nurse has created a "Calm Corner" to develop stress relieving and coping techniques to help students to return to class. At the Andrews Middle School nurses are working to increase student time in learning by helping students manage anxiety. At the Brooks Elementary School nurses are expanding care coordination services for students with ongoing complex health care needs. At the Columbus Elementary School, the nurses are educating students on asthma and the brain/behavior connection. At the McGlynn Elementary and Middle Schools the nurses created a bulletin board where health information is posted for students on topics such as flu prevention, dental hygiene, and making healthy choices about nutrition and physical fitness. At the Roberts Elementary School, the nurses are working to coordinate care for newly immigrated families. Ms. Kreatz - What sort of conditions were leading students to request Tylenol? Ms. Wray - It was all different things, part of it was teasing out the condition and figuring out what was really wrong. Ms. Mustone - Do the nurses follow up with doctors? Ms. Wray - That is part of our role. Ms. Mustone - Is that time consuming? Ms. Wray - Yes, but the goal is to get students back to class. Ms. Mustone - As the state mandates more and more of your profession, is there a new role for case workers in your office? Ms. Wray - It is all wrapped up in the role of the school nurse. We as school nurses have been doing this for a long time, but as student needs expand, we have been expanding our expertise. Mr. Ruseau - Does your department come together to share best practices and replicate these to the other schools? Ms. Wray - We do it in a staff meeting format. Mr. Ruseau - Do you track students who have many visits per year? Ms. Wray - I place a lot of independence on the building-based nurses and allow them to meet those needs. I can pull that information up myself, as needed. Ms. McLaughlin - At the Brooks School, is there a number of students that are visiting the nurse's office more than 300 times per year? Ms. Wray - I would have to work with Kim Myles to see that. Ms. McLaughlin - There are rising concerns about anxiety. Do you know when parents might be notified? Ms. Wray - It would not be at a certain number, it would be when building a relationship, when it feels above and beyond a certain level, it seems to be something that needs to be seen by a doctor. Ms. McLaughlin - I want to ask about telephone translation services. Ms. Wray - We use it for short phone calls, such as notifying parents that a child has a fever. It is a per minute charge and it is expensive but we only use it for short calls right now.

Ms. DeSouza - What would be other ways to help students who request Tylenol? Ms. Wray - Make sure students are hydrated. Make sure students have eaten. Make sure the student has gotten enough rest. It tends to be very basic strategies that everybody can use. Ms. DeSouza - What if a student comes in and has had a rough night, would you just send them back to class? Ms. Wray - We will hydrate them, give them a snack, and sometimes we will offer them Tylenol. It is about education and building a healthy lifestyle. Ms. DeSouza - Who offers translation services? Ms. Wray - We give them the phone number. I am not sure who does the service. It is an outside professional service.

Report on English Learners - Paul Teixeira - To answer Ms. DeSouza's question: It is like three-way calling with a translator. We are now engaged in ACCESS testing to make determinations for the next school year. The high school has completed testing with the exception of make-ups. The rest of the schools are completing them now. We will be completed by January 26th. We have to balance the testing for technology purposes. I have included the report of ACCESS scores for you to ask questions. Ms. Mustone - It appears that all scores were improvements except for the high school and the Columbus Elementary. Mr. Teixeira - If you look at the Columbus, they made a big jump from 2017 to 2018, so I think it was a leveling off. We get a report from the state from each student who has not made progress and each teacher gets a progress monitoring form for that student. The student gets a building based team, they receive Title 1. They identify areas of need and interventions. That should continue to boost scores. At Medford High School we looked at our curriculum and added another class. We added a 1.5 level class for students who came in and were not here for a full year, who maybe needed some additional time to learn. Mr. Ruseau - I am impressed and thankful that your work is considered a blueprint for the state. Ms. McLaughlin - It says NA for the Brooks. Mr. Teixeira - There are not enough EL students at the Brooks to collect data but I get individual reports for the students.

Ms. Kreatz - How long does it take students to take the ACCESS test online? Mr. Teixeira - It is different for all grade levels. The Kindergarten students take about an hour. For grades one to twelves, they take about 30 to 40 minutes of listening, then they take a break before they start reading, then it takes about 60 to 70 minutes. The next day they come back and do the writing portion for 60 to 70 minutes, then speaking portion for 60 to 70 minutes. The final portion depends on proficiency.

Ms. Graham - This report was easy to digest.

Ms. McLaughlin - How many students did the Columbus program increase by in 2017-2018?
Mr. Teixeira - They have always hovered between 75 and 90 students. They went up 24%.

Motion to accept offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on Credit for Life - Dr. Bernadette Ricciardelli - We are here to announce the third annual Credit for Life Fair which will take place on April 3rd, 2020. This will be our best year of the program. We are the recipient of a grant, this year for \$2,500, made possible by the Massachusetts Division of Banks in partnership with the State Treasurer's Office. It is a great opportunity for students to learn to make real-world decisions about saving, spending, and budgeting money on a host of career choices and lifestyle decisions. This year the program will be mandatory for all grade 11 students, approximately 311 students. Gail Treanor will speak to you about the work she will be doing with the math teachers. Ms. Treanor - Last year we started talking with the math teachers to incorporate some of the financial aspects of the fair. The students choose a profession, and they get a salary, including deductions, a credit score, including certain conditions on loans, a student loan payment, etc. They have to understand certain calculations. The math teachers have been great and enthusiastic about presenting the concepts to students. The financial vocabulary is also very important because that is something they need to know to understand the various stations they go to in the fair. Dr. Ricciardelli - Lisa Evangelista is the coordinator of volunteers throughout the fair. Ms. Evangelista - This fair cannot be done without the volunteers. We have the community run the fair rather than stopping classes in order to run the stations. We have wonderful representation from community members and business leaders. They also provide raffle prizes for the students. Ms. Kreatz - I look forward to the fair again this year. I wonder if we can add a presentation on banking, writing a check and what sort of identification you need. Dr. Ricciardelli - The math department and social studies department both have financial literacy curricula. We can incorporate check writing into the fair, but I do think both of those electives have check writing. Ms. McLaughlin - Is it too soon for community members to volunteer? Should they speak with you, Lisa? Ms. Evangelista - Yes. Ms. Van der Kloot - I am happy to hear that you will be extending it to the middle schools. Ms. Graham - Can we update people in the community on what we do for financial literacy?

Motion to put out a press release on financial literacy across the district offered by Ms. Graham, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Ms. DeSouza - Last year I participated in the Credit for Life Fair. It was a lot of fun. Are 12th graders allowed to go again? Dr. Ricciardelli - Just 11th graders. Ms. DeSouza - There were crowds and long lines at the end. Ms. Treanor - That was an issue last year, we have a plan for that. We will break out the tables at the end to fix it.

Motion to receive and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Report on Medford Community Fund Awards - Diane Caldwell - The Medford Community Fund announced the 2019 recipients of the \$125,000 Community Fund payments from Encore Boston. The Fund, tagline: "All In Medford" (AIM) hopes to have a positive impact on Medford residents.

Ms. Kreatz - We encourage any non-profit organizations to apply next year. The application will come out annually, in late September/October. Ms. Van der Kloot - As a member of the Medford Education Foundation we were pleased to be awarded funds and the money will go right back to Medford schools. Ms. McLaughlin - For folks that want to apply next year, you have to be a 501(c)3, correct? Ms. Kreatz - Yes. Ms. McLaughlin - How was the RFP made? Ms. Kreatz - It was a press release and it was on the website, shared on social media. We posted the deadline when we got it.

Motion to receive report and place on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Ms. Kreatz - We heard from teachers that needed to buy supplies. I want to make sure when we go into the pre-budget season that we consider manipulatives in the budget.

Motion to look into math supplies as we enter the pre-budget season offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Request to Present New Options for Agenda Formatting - Motion to send to Rules Subcommittee offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Mayor Lungo-Koehn read condolences for Francis Caratelli and Vincent Zampell.

Motion to adjourn offered by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Meeting adjourned at 8:27pm.